

Clean mobility that pays people.

No subsidy. No budget line. No expiry date.

Please note, this is the current but not final version of the poster. There are likely some small edits to be made before it is final.

M-Tokens are a proposed digital form of Tradable Fuel Permits. Government sets a declining quarterly quantity of fossil fuel for the light fleet. People receive all of it, free. Organisations receive none and must buy. So every litre you don't burn — because you electrified, switched fuel, drove less, or drove differently — becomes something you can sell.

THE UNIT
One M-Token is the right to purchase the quantity of fossil fuel for light-fleet use whose combustion emits one kilogram of carbon dioxide equivalent.

WHY PRICE ALONE WILL NOT DO IT
Upstream carbon pricing is never likely to rise high enough to strongly influence individual mobility choices. ETS2 has now been postponed to 2028 amid concern about energy prices and vulnerable households.

THE POLITICAL ARITHMETIC

ESTIMATED HOUSEHOLDS IN SURPLUS

2/3

of households are estimated to hold surplus M-Tokens in the initial period.

ESTIMATED VOTERS

3/4

of voters are estimated to live in a household with surplus.

WHAT UPSTREAM CARBON PRICING ADDS

€0.23

to a litre of petrol, for each additional 100 euro per tonne of carbon dioxide equivalent.

Preliminary modelling using New Zealand data — initial-period estimates, driven by the treatment of organisation demand.

HOW THE MONEY MOVES

The value of scarcity is assigned to people — not to fuel suppliers, and not to the Crown.

GOVERNMENT

Sets a multi-year declining light-fleet fossil-fuel budget (households and organisations) and issues it as M-Tokens each quarter.

ALLOCATES FREE

PEOPLE

Receive 100% of M-Tokens, free, every quarter. Allocated by mobility need, not in equal shares.

SELL SURPLUS

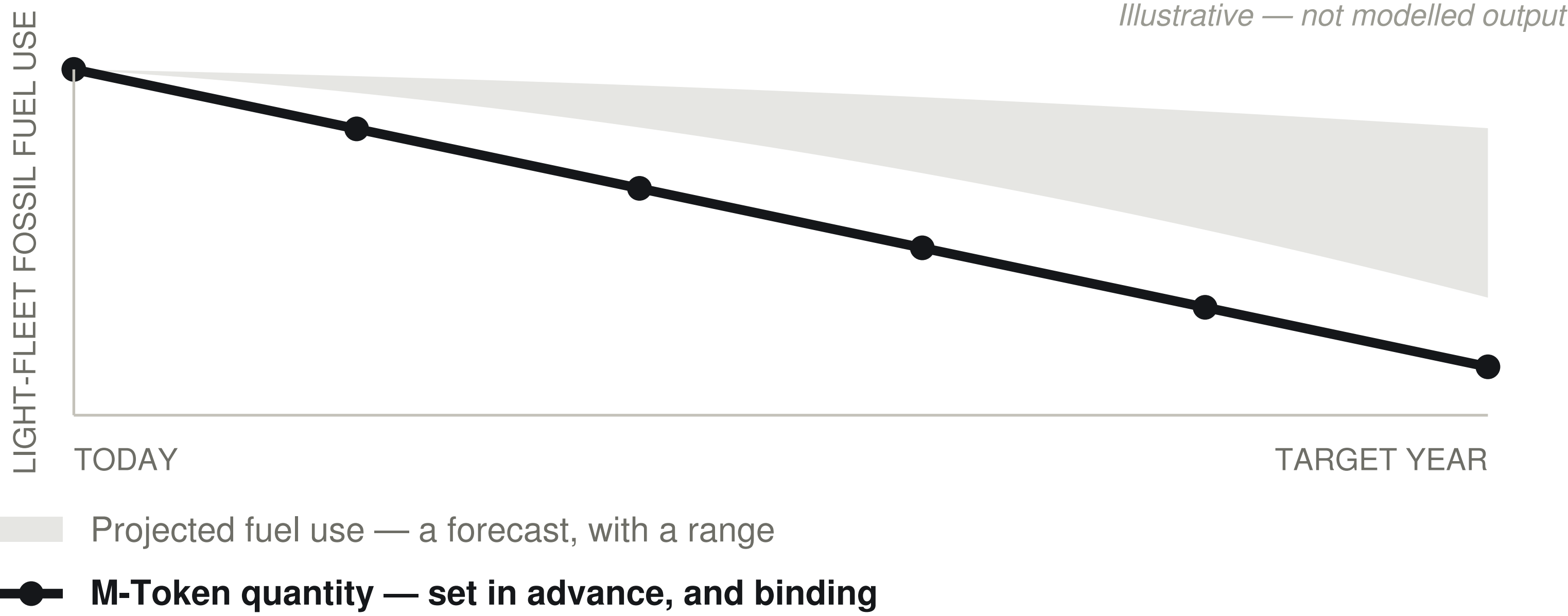
ORGANISATIONS

Receive none. Must acquire every M-Token they surrender — which creates the demand that pays people.

PAYMENT FLOWS BACK TO PEOPLE, EVERY QUARTER

SET THE QUANTITY, LET THE PRICE FOLLOW

A pathway, not a projection.



WHAT A QUANTITY CONSTRAINT REACHES

- 01 **The vehicles already on the road** — A fuel constraint acts on every fossil-fuelled kilometre, not only on new-vehicle buyers.
- 02 **Technology-neutral by construction** — Electrification, mode shift, fuel switching and fewer trips all earn the same way.
- 03 **The price reflects decarbonisation** — As the fleet decarbonises, demand for M-Tokens falls, keeping prices stable.
- 04 **The upstream carbon price stays intact** — M-Tokens sit downstream of emissions trading/carbon tax rather than replacing.

WHAT M-TOKENS WOULD NOT DO

They would not decarbonise anything by themselves. They would make continued fossil-fuel use progressively scarcer and more expensive *on a known schedule*, and leave people and organisations to decide how to respond. Whether that produces the response the theory predicts is an empirical question — and an open one. A policy pilot should be the end of an evidence pathway, not the beginning.

THE ASK

I am looking for a team.

Not to assume Tradable Fuel Permits would work — to define the evidence that would justify, or rule out, a real-world pilot. The conference plans follow-up workshops, and I would like one of them to be this one.

01 **Mobility choice and behaviour** — would the constraint change trip, mode and vehicle choices?

02 **Equity, distribution, and acceptability** — who gains, who pays, can allocation rules protect people, and would they vote for it?

03 **Economics and market design** — how do price, liquidity and banking behave as quantity falls?

04 **Policy, governance and digital systems** — coexistence with ETS/carbon tax, road pricing, identity, payments and fuel retail.

